The Bureau of Meteorology

IDS11074
Australian Government Bureau of Meteorology
South Australia

Coastal Waters Forecast for South Australia
Gulf Waters

Issued at 9:30 am CDT on Thursday 22 October 2026
for the period until midnight CDT Saturday 24 October 2026.

Please be aware
Wind and wave forecasts are averages. Wind gusts can be 40 per cent stronger than the forecast, and stronger still in squalls and thunderstorms. Maximum waves can be twice the forecast height.

Warning Information

For latest warnings go to www.bom.gov.au, subscribe to RSS feeds, call 1300 659 210* or listen for warnings on relevant TV and radio broadcasts.

Weather Situation

A slow moving high pressure system in the Tasman Sea maintains a ridge across eastern parts of the state. A trough of low pressure is forecast to move into the west on Thursday, and slowly move eastwards on Friday. Another trough and multiple cold fronts move over the state over the weekend.

Spencer Gulf

Forecast for Thursday 22 October until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly 10 to 15 knots shifting south to southeasterly below 10 knots during the afternoon and evening then becoming variable in the late evening. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming south to southwesterly 15 to 20 knots in the morning. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the afternoon. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 25 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1.5 to 2 metres during the evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres south of Cowell to Wallaroo. Weather: Partly cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

Gulf St Vincent

Forecast for Thursday 22 October until midnight

Winds: Variable about 10 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable about 10 knots becoming southerly 15 to 20 knots in the middle of the day. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: South to southwesterly below 1 metre. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm.

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Central Coast

Forecast for Thursday 22 October until midnight

Winds: Northerly 10 to 15 knots turning west to northwesterly below 10 knots in the afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming west to southwesterly 10 to 15 knots before dawn then turning southerly 15 to 20 knots early in the morning. Seas: Around 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres inshore by early evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: Southerly about 10 knots increasing to 15 to 20 knots during the day. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: Southwesterly 3 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the morning and afternoon.

Investigator Strait

Forecast for Thursday 22 October until midnight

Winds: North to northeasterly about 10 knots increasing to 10 to 15 knots in the morning then becoming variable about 10 knots in the early afternoon. Seas: Below 1 metre. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 1.5 metres. Weather: Mostly sunny.

Forecast for Friday 23 October

Winds: Variable below 10 knots becoming southwesterly 10 to 15 knots in the early morning then tending southerly in the late afternoon. Winds reaching up to 20 knots through the Backstairs Passage in the evening. Seas: Below 0.5 metres, increasing to around 1 metre during the morning. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Partly cloudy.

Forecast for Saturday 24 October

Winds: South to southeasterly 15 to 20 knots. Seas: Below 1 metre, increasing to 1 to 1.5 metres during the evening. Swell: West to southwesterly 1 to 2 metres. Weather: Cloudy. 95% chance of showers. The chance of a thunderstorm in the afternoon.

The next routine forecast will be issued at 3:30 pm CDT Thursday.

* Calls to 1300 numbers cost around 27.5c incl. GST, higher from mobiles or public phones. Marine forecasts are also available on VHF and HF radio. View the radio schedule on www.bom.gov.au/marine

Check the latest Coastal Waters Forecasts for information on wind, wave and weather conditions for neighbouring coastal zones.

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